Mesa
SCHOOL OF BUSINESS

A FOUNDER'S PLAYBOOK

The First 10 Customers

How to win your first paying customers in B2B and high-value sales — from cold outreach to a signed deal.



OUR AGENDA

The path to your first sale.

01	**The Mindset**	The lead funnel and your new role as a founder
02	**Consistency**	Mastering the art of cold outreach
03	**The Conversation**	Pitching, proving value and the first “yes”
04	**The Close**	Pricing, negotiation and getting paid
05	**The Follow-Through**	From closed deal to delighted partner
06	**Your Mission**	The 20-minute lead-gen sprint

Let’s be honest: “sales” can feel intimidating.

COMMON FEARS

“I don’t want to be pushy or annoying.”

“What if they say no?”

“I’m a builder, not a ‘salesperson’.”

TODAY’S REFRAME

You are a founder and a problem-solver. Your job is simply to offer solutions.

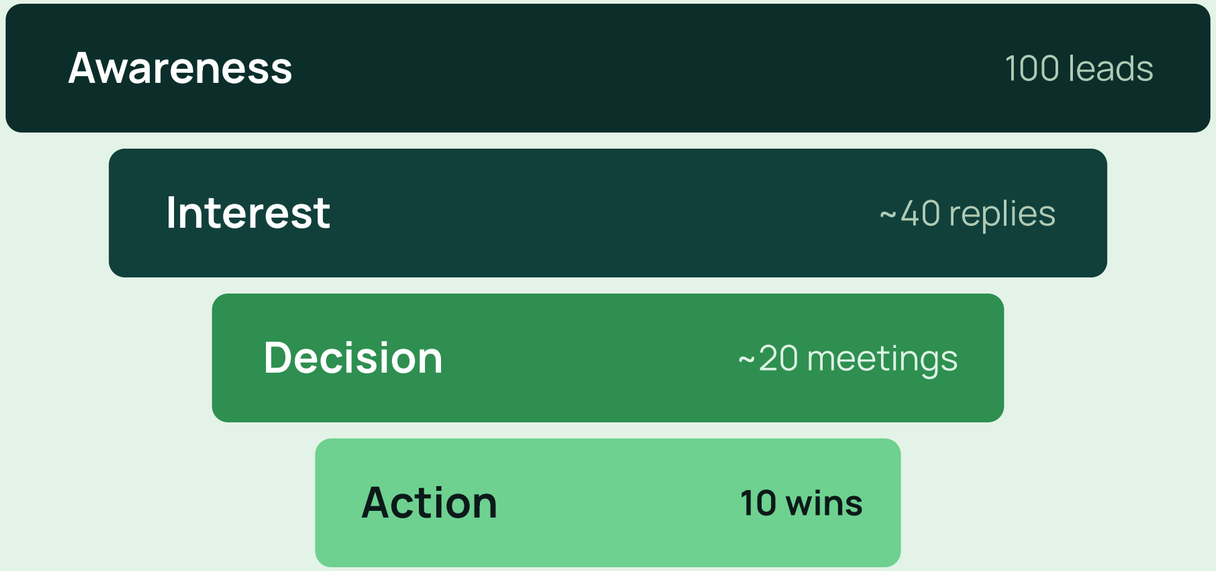


YOUR NEW MAP

The B2B sales funnel.

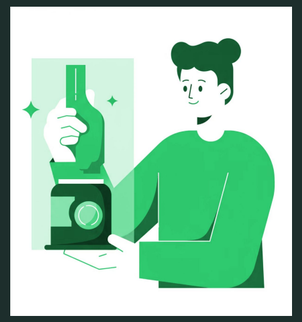
Sales is a numbers game. To land **10 customers** , you may need to reach out to **100 potential leads**.

Your job is to systematically move people from the top of the funnel to the bottom — a few drop away at every stage, and that is exactly how it should work.



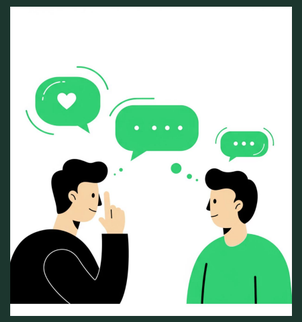
THE GOLDEN RULE OF COLD OUTREACH

Lead with their world, not yours.



It’s not about your product.

Nobody cares about your solution — not yet.

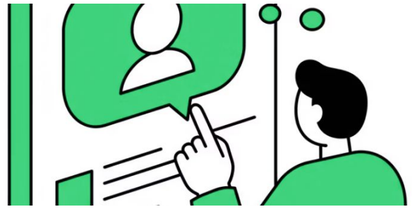


It’s about their problems.

Start every message in the world they already live in.

PLAYBOOK 01

The LinkedIn playbook.



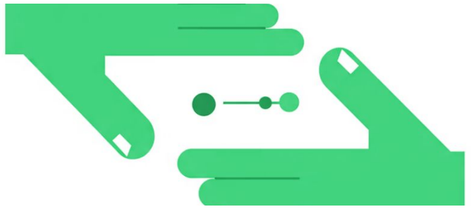
1 Connect

Send a personalized connection request.



2 Comment

Engage with their posts for 1–2 days.



3 Converse (DM)

Send a short, problem-focused message.

TEMPLATE

“Hi [Name], enjoyed your post on [Topic]. I’m building a venture at Mesa that helps [Their Role] solve [Problem]. Would you be open to a 15-min chat to share your perspective?”

PLAYBOOK 02

The cold email playbook.

SUBJECT LINE GOAL

Curiosity, not a sales pitch. e.g. “Question about [Their Company]’s gifting”



Problem — name a problem your prospect likely faces.



Solution — hint at how your venture helps.



Credibility — your role, or a mutual connection.



Call to action — a low-friction next step.

TEMPLATE

“Hi [Name], I’m a founder at Mesa School of Business. I noticed many companies struggle with [Problem]. Our venture is building a solution. Given your expertise, I’d value your feedback. Are you free for a quick call next week?”

PLAYBOOK 03

The networking playbook.

When someone asks, **“What do you do?”**

DON’T SAY

“I sell X.”

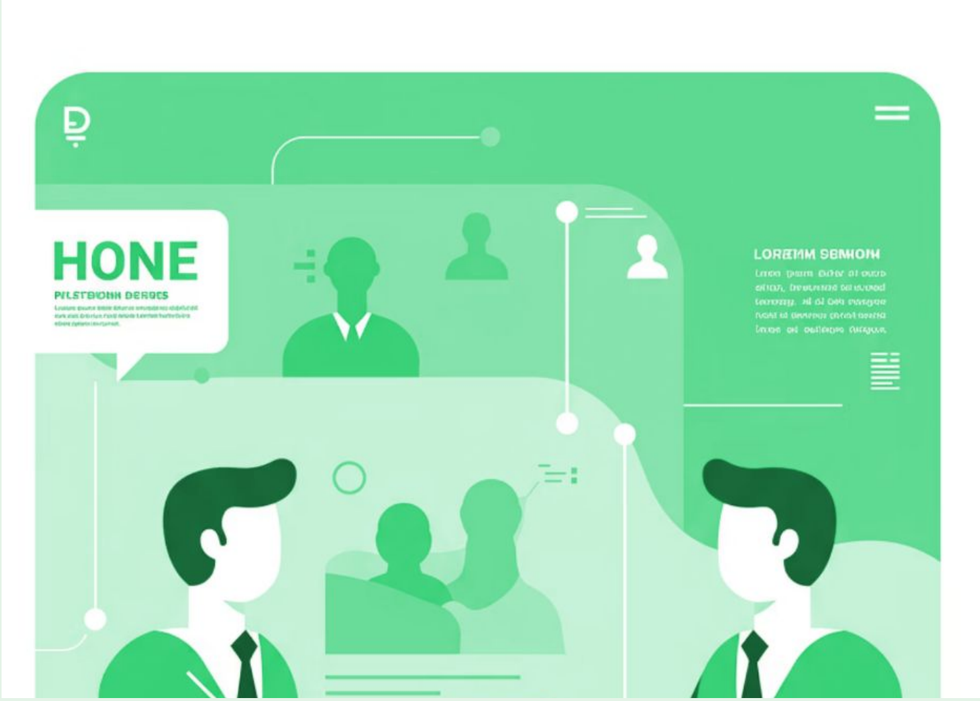
DO SAY

“I’m a founder at Mesa, and we’re helping companies solve [Problem]. It’s been fascinating learning about [Their Industry].”

The goal is to start a conversation about **their** problems.

PLAYBOOK 04

The warm intro playbook.



Make it easy for your connection to help you.

TEMPLATE

“Hi [Mutual Friend], hope you’re well. I saw you’re connected to [Target Person]. We’re building a solution for [Problem] and I think they’d be perfect for feedback. Would you be comfortable making a brief email intro? I’ve included a short, forwardable blurb below to make it easy.”

THEY REPLIED! YOUR ONLY GOAL

Get the meeting.

DON'T

Try to sell in the email or DM.

DO

Immediately pivot to scheduling a call.

TEMPLATE

"That's great to hear! To make it easy, here's a link to my calendar to find a 15-minute slot that works for you: [Your Calendly Link]"

YOUR PITCH COLLATERAL

The 3-slide mini-deck.

You don’t need a 20-page deck. You need a simple, clean PDF to share.

SLIDE 1

The Problem

SLIDE 2

The Solution

Your product

SLIDE 3

The Value

Key benefits

The value-first close.

Sell the solution before you sell the product. On your first call, get them to agree the solution is valuable — before they know the cost.

KEY QUESTIONS TO ASK

“Does this sound like something that would solve the problem we discussed?”

“If this worked perfectly, what impact would that have on your business?”

How to price a B2B deal.

1 Cost-Plus the safe start

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(Cost of goods) × 2.5 = B2B price
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e.g. ₹300 COGS → **₹750 B2B price**

2 Value-Based the pro move

Price on the value you create. “Our solution saves your team 10 hours — worth ₹5,000 to you. Our price is ₹2,000.”

Recommendation: start with a simple cost-plus model.

The negotiation playbook.

Negotiation is a conversation, not a fight.

01

Anchor High

Always start with your list price.

02

The Flinch

When they ask for a discount, pause. Don’t agree immediately.

03

The Trade-Off

Never give a discount without getting something in return — a larger order, faster payment.



SEALING THE DEAL

The 1-page proposal.

After the call, send a formal proposal. It must include:

Scope of Work

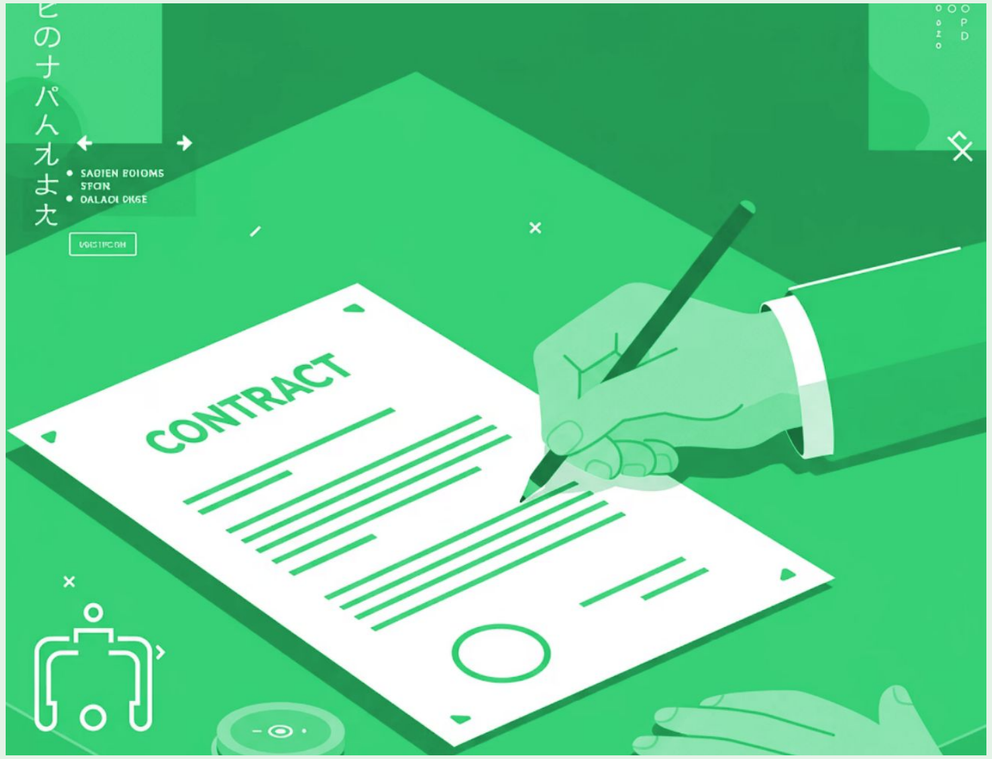
Exactly what they are getting.

Total Price & Payment Terms

The final negotiated price, and when it's due.

Timeline

The delivery date.



POST-SALES CLOSURE

The real work begins.

You got the “yes”. Now, deliver excellence.



Send the Invoice

Immediately.



Confirm Payment

Before you start work.



Kick-Off Call

Set a confirmation call.



Over-Communicate

Regular status updates.

The 5 cardinal sins of B2B sales.

Premature Pitching

Don’t sell in the first interaction. Build rapport and understand their needs first.

Lack of Research

Reaching out without researching the prospect shows a lack of respect.

Discounting Without Value

Never discount without something of equal value in return.

Neglecting Follow-Up

Many deals are lost to weak follow-up. Persist, but always add value.

Missing a Deadline

Failing to deliver on time erodes trust and damages credibility.

IN-CLASS TASK · 20 MINUTES

The lead-gen sprint.

1 Create your Ideal Customer Profile (5 min)

Industry, company size, and job title of your perfect first customer.

2 Find 5 real people (5 min)

Use LinkedIn to find 5 people who match your profile.

3 Draft your outreach templates (10 min)

A personalized LinkedIn request and a cold email for these 5 people.



YOUR HOMEWORK

Get in the game.

1. Send at least **20 personalized** outreach messages (LinkedIn / email).
2. Secure at least **5 “yes, I’m interested”** replies.
3. Prepare your **3-slide mini-deck.**



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Q&A

Sell the problem, not the product — then go win your first ten.